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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/MGU-BBA (Honours)/MGU-BCA (Honours) Special Examinations, July 2026 (for 2024 Admission Regular Examinations, October 2025)

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCENG200 - AN INTRODUCTION TO PHONETICS

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

Scheme of Valuation

Part A - MCQ

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1.	b). Sound changes in the PIE /k/sound	[K] / [CO1
2.	a). /iː/	[U] / [CO2]
3.	b). /h/, /j/, /w/	[U] / [CO3]
4.	a). Greek	[U] / [CO4]
5.	a). Daniel Jones	[U] / [CO1]
6.	c). Closing	[U] / [CO2]
7.	b). /kɑː/	[U] / [CO3]
8.	b). Omission of /v/	[U] / [CO4]
9.	c). Yes	[U] / [CO2]
10.	c). /r/	[K] / [CO3]

[1x10 = 10]

Part B - SHORT ANSWER

Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11, The Scientific study of language is called linguistics - branches of linguistics - a) Syntax – the rules governing sentence structure b) Semantics - the study of meaning in language c) Pragmatics – how meaning is influenced by context d) Morphology – the internal structure of words e) Sociolinguistics – the relationship between language and society f) Phonology -the abstract sound systems of language g) Phonetics- the physical properties of speech sounds [U] / [CO1]

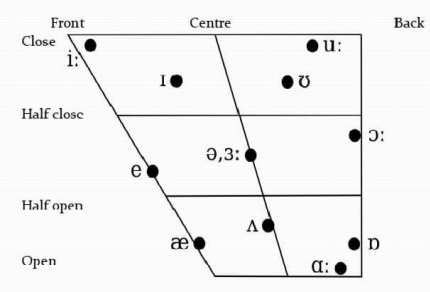
12. /stei/, /stəʊn/, /kɪŋ/, /feʧ/, /ɑːm/, /dʒɒb/, /tuːl/ / /keɪdʒ/, /muːv/, /swiːt/ [A] / [CO2]

13 Minimal pairs are pairs of words that have different meanings and differ by one sound in the same position. Eg /pin/ /bin/- They help identify phonemes by proving that switching one sound changes the meaning of a word. [U] / [CO3]

14. A chain of phonemes that form speech segments and consonant clusters are known as segmental features. Certain aspects of speech such as stress, pitch and length affect how sounds are perceived. These are called suprasegmentals or sound attributes. Segmental features relate to individual vowels and consonants; suprasegmentals shape the rhythm, melody and overall flow of speech. [U] / [CO4]

15. Modern English vocabulary expanded due to historical, cultural, scientific and technological advancement. – influence of Renaissance-Impact of Reformation -Borrowing from other languages – Influence of globalisation – continuous evolution [U] / [CO1]

16.



A vowel diagram is a visual representation of the position of the tongue during the articulation of vowel sounds. It is usually a trapezoid or quadrilateral representing the oral cavity. The vertical axis represents the tongue height, while the horizontal axis represents tongue advancement. A vowel diagram helps in understanding how vowels are produced and how they differ from each other based on tongue position. [U] / [CO2]

17. Approximants are consonant sounds produced when the articulators come close to each other but do not create enough narrowing to produce turbulent airflow (friction). They are all voiced in English - produced with a narrow but incomplete closure of the vocal tract. No friction or turbulent airflow is created during articulation. All English approximants are voiced, meaning the vocal cords vibrate. Air flows smoothly through the mouth. They are classified into central approximants (air passes over the centre of the tongue) and lateral approximants (air passes around the sides of the tongue). Approximants are often divided into: Semivowels (glides): /j/ and /w/Liquids: /r/ and /l/ [U] / [CO3]

18. Sense groups, also known as tone groups, express one complete idea in spoken language. Each sense group has one nuclear syllable. It makes a long sentence easy to understand emphasize the important information through stress and intonation - Makes natural speech fluent. [U] / [CO4]

19. a·rrived — Primary stress falls on the second syllable ($/'raɪvd/$). ho·tel — Primary stress falls on the second syllable /ˈtel/). She (pronoun), at (preposition), and the (definite article) are unstressed in natural speech [U] / [CO4]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C - ESSAY

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. Speech is a complex activity involving multiple organs – the **respiratory system** initiates speech, providing airflow. It comprises lungs, diaphragm, intercostal muscles and the trachea. Air pushed out from lungs called pulmonic egressive airstream. **Phonatory system** -larynx and vocal folds. Converts airflow into sounds through vibration of vocal folds. Responsible for voice production. Voiced and Voiceless Sounds – Types of Phonation -**Articulatory System-** Shapes airstream into speech sounds. Includes tongue, lips, teeth nasal and oral cavities – Responsible for articulation. Roof of the mouth – Alveolar ridge, hard palate, soft palate, uvula. Oral and nasal sounds Part of the tongue and lips

[U] / [CO1]

21.The Cardinal Vowel System, developed by Daniel Jones, is an internationally accepted framework for describing vowel sounds. It consists of 16 reference vowels—8 primary and 8

secondary.Primary cardinal vowels -[i] [e] [ɛ] [ɛ] [ɑ] [ɔ] [o] [u Secondary cardinal vowels-]y] [ø] [œ] [œ] [ɒ] [ʌ] [ɤ] [ɯ] The primary vowels define the extreme positions of the tongue, while the secondary vowels are formed by reversing the lip-rounding of their primary counterparts. Together, they provide a comprehensive and universal system for describing and comparing the vowels of all languages. [U] / [CO2]

22. Consonant clusters are sequences of two or more consonants without intervening vowels.-onset clusters-occur at the beginning of syllables; coda clusters-occur at the end of syllables; medial clusters – occur within words and may be divided across syllables. Consonant cluster occur within single syllable /str/ in street /spl/ in splash abutting consonant happen across syllable boundaries where one syllable ends with a consonant and the next syllable begins with another as in /t/ and /n/ in catnip /k/ and /t/ in blacktop

[K] / [CO3]

23 **Salesman:** /ˌgʊd ˈmɔː.nɪŋ ˌsɜːr! ↘ | ˈmeɪ aɪ ˈhɛlp juː? ↗/

Customer: /ˈjɛs, ↗ | aɪm ˈlʊk.ɪŋ fɔːr ə ˈbɜːrθ.deɪ ˈprɛz.ənt ↘ | fɔːr maɪ ˈdɔː.tər. ↘/

Salesman: /wiː hæv ˈdʒiːnz, ↗ | ˈtɒps, ↗ | ˈʃɔːts ↗ | ənd bɜːrˈmjuː.dəz. ↘/

Customer: /aɪ ˈdaʊt maɪ tʃɔɪs wʊd ˈmætʃ hɜːr teɪst. ↘ | ðæt ˈwɒtʃ lʊks ˈɪn.trə.stɪŋ. ↘/

Salesman: /ðæts ə ˈrɑː.dəʊ, sɜːr, ↗ | ə rɪˈpjuː.tɪd əˈmɛr.ɪ.kən brænd. ↘/

Customer: /ɪt dʌz lʊk ˈɛl.ɪ.gənt. ↘ | bʌt wɒt əˈbaʊt əʊˈmɛg.ə ↗ | ɔːr kɑːrˈtiːeɪ? ↗/

Salesman: /ðeɪr əˈveɪ.lə.bəl ˈtuː, ↗ | ðəʊ kwaɪt ɪkˈspɛn.sɪv. ↘ | ˈmeɪ aɪ ˈæsk jɔːr ˈbʌdʒ.ɪt? ↘/

Customer: /aɪ wɒz ˈθɪŋ.kɪŋ ɒv ˈsʌm.θɪŋ laɪk ˈseɪ.kəʊ ↗ | ɔːr ˈkæs.i.əʊ. ↘/

Salesman: /aɪ ʌn.dərˈstænd. ↘ | ˈtuː biː ˈhɒʊ.nɪst, ↗ | ðɪs ˈɪz.ənt ə ˈspɛʃ.ə.lɪst ˈwɒtʃ ʃɒp. ↘ | wiː ˈəʊn.li kiːp ə fjuː sɪˈlɛkt ˈpiː.sɪz. ↘ | ɪf juː laɪk, ↗ | hɪərz ə ˈwɔːl klɒk wɪð ə ˈkʊk.uː bɜːrd ↗ | ðæt ˈkɔːlz aʊt ˈɛv.ri ˈaʊər. ↘ | ˈtʃɪl.drən ˈjuː.ʒu.ə.li lʌv ɪt. ↘ | ˈduː juː hæv ˈgrænd ˌtʃɪl.drən? ↗/

Customer: /ˈjɛs, aɪ duː. ↘ | ðeɪ maɪt ɪnˈdʒɔɪ ðæt. ↘ | bʌt ˈɪz ðɛər ˈɛni.θɪŋ ˈɛls? ↗/

Salesman: /ˈsɜːr.tən.li. ↘ | ˈhɪərz ə ˈtʃaɪ.niːz mɪŋ veɪz — ↗ | ən ˌɪm.ɪˈteɪ.ʃən, ↗ | bʌt ˈbjuː.tɪ.fəli ˈkrɑː.ftɪd ↗ | ənd ˈvɛri ˈstrɑɪ.kɪŋ. ↘/

Customer: /juːr raɪt, ↘ | ɪt lʊks kwaɪt əˈtræk.tɪv. ↘/

Salesman: /ˈθæŋk juː. ↘ | ɪf jʊr ˈɪn.trə.stɪd, ↗ | wiː ˈɔːl.səʊ hæv ˈpeɪn.tɪŋz. ↘/

Customer: /aɪ θɪŋk aɪv dɪˈsaɪ.dɪd. ↘ | ðə veɪz ɪz ˈpɜːr.fɪkt, ↘ | ənd ðə praɪs ɪz fɛər. ↘ | ˈkʊd juː pæk ɪt fɔːr miː? ↗/

Salesman: /ɒv ˈkɔːrs, sɜːr. ↘ | ˈθæŋk juː vɛri mʌtʃ. ↘/ [A] / [CO4]

[15x2 = 30]